DINNER

in 30 minutes



One-pan Mexican Quinoa



1 TB olive oil
2 cloves garlic, minced
1 jalapeño, minced
1 C quinoa
1 C vegetable broth
1 (15 oz.) can black beans, drained and rinsed
1 (14.5 oz.) can diced tomatoes
1 C frozen corn
1 tsp. chili powder
½ tsp. cumin
Salt and pepper, to taste
Optional: 1 avocado, juice of 1 lime, 2 TB chopped fresh cilantro

1. Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium high heat. Add garlic and jalapeno. Cook, stirring frequently, until fragrant, about 1 minute.
2. Stir in quinoa, vegetable broth, beans, tomatoes, corn, chili powder, and cumin. Season with salt and pepper, to taste.
3. Bring to a boil. Cover, reduce heat and simmer until quinoa is cooked through, about 20 minutes. If desired, stir in avocado, lime juice, and cilantro.

Recipe and picture courtesy of damndelicious.net

Swift Stir-Fry

1-2 chicken breasts, cut into thin 2-inch strips (can use beef)
1/4 C + 2 TB of Mr. Yoshida's Marinade and Cooking Sauce
16 oz. bag of frozen stir-fry vegetable mix
1/2 C water
2 tbsp. cornstarch
Optional: ½ C cashews

1. Marinate meat in 2 TB of sauce. Meanwhile, cook vegetables in stir-fry pan (coated with cooking spray) on high for about 3-4 minutes. Remove vegetables to serving dish; cover to keep warm.
2. Sautee chicken on high until juices run clear, approx. 5 minutes. Meanwhile, whisk ¼ cup sauce, water, and cornstarch together until smooth. Over medium heat, add sauce mixture to chicken and heat to bubbling and thickened, about 2-3 minutes.
3. Stir in cashews, if desired. Add vegetables. Serve over rice.

Recipe courtesy of Kaylene Craig

Broccoli Chickpea Stir-Fry

2 tbsp. olive oil
1 small onion, thinly sliced
4 cloves garlic, minced
Salt and pepper
1 ½ heads broccoli, including stalks, trimmed and chopped (2 cups)
1 (10.5 oz.) can chickpeas (aka garbanzo beans), drained and rinsed
1/3 C chicken or vegetable broth
¼ tsp. crushed red pepper
1/3 C parmesan cheese (grated or shaved)

1. In a large skillet (preferably one with a lid), warm olive oil over medium heat until hot. Carefully add onion, garlic, and salt. Sautee, stirring often, until onion becomes transparent and garlic just begins to turn golden brown, 4 to 5 minutes.
2. Toss in chopped broccoli. Sautee for 3 minutes. Add chickpeas, broth, and red pepper. Stir once, cover, and cook for 3-9 minutes more. Cooking time will depend on how soft you like your broccoli.
3. Uncover, season with pepper, sprinkle with parmesan, and serve! Enjoy this spicy dish. The textures of the broccoli and chickpea complement each other well.

Recipe courtesy of myrecipe.com

Baked Potatoes

1 potato for each person (if they are very small, 1-2 per person)
Toppings: cheese, broccoli, other veggies, chili, butter, sour cream, salt and pepper

1. Scrub potatoes and rinse with water. Poke fork into potatoes to make air holes.
2. Bake in a glass dish with lid in the microwave or wrap in foil and bake in the oven at 400° for 1 hour.
3. Prepare toppings: boil or steam vegetables; heat chili; grate cheese; get out butter, salt, pepper, and sour cream. Once potatoes are done, let cool for about 5 minutes before cutting and adding toppings.



Ham and Cheese Oven Sandwiches

The cook time for this recipe is just 30 minutes, but it does take some time to prepare the dough. All you have to do is leave it out all day to rise and when you come home from class to make dinner, your dough is ready to go!

1 Rhodes “Bake n Serve” loaf of bread
Deli ham
Mozzarella cheese

1. Let dough sit out all day to rise.
2. Roll out and put ham and cheese out in one layer alternating.
3. Bake at 350° for 20-25 minutes.

Tuna Casserole

Noodles of choice, cooked al dente and drained
1 can cream of chicken or mushroom
1 can tuna, drained
Milk, start with ½ of soup can
Salt and pepper
Optional: Vegetables to stir in

1. Cook your noodles of choice until they are al dente. Drain the noodles and add them back to their pot, keeping the stove on low heat.
2. Stir in the cream of chicken or cream of mushroom soup, tuna, and milk. Stir all the ingredients to combine. Add more milk to reach desired consistency.
3. Add salt and pepper to taste and other seasonings as desired such as onion powder, garlic powder, parsley, Italian seasonings, etc.
4. Optional: add your favorite cooked vegetable into the tuna casserole or serve on the side. Peas work especially well when cooked with the noodles.

Pasta

Pasta is a really easy dish to make and can be stored and used as leftovers too. Plus, it is easily customizable as you can add your favorite type of sauce and even some meat or vegetables. Directions for cooking pasta are usually on the packages they come in. Here are some simple pasta recipes!

Skinny Alfredo Sauce

12 ounces fettuccine (or whatever type of pasta you like)
1 Tablespoon extra virgin olive oil or butter
4 cloves garlic, pressed or finely-minced
3 Tablespoons all-purpose flour
1 cup chicken stock
1 cup low-fat milk (could use non-dairy milk, but that might change the flavor)
3/4 cup freshly-grated Parmesan cheese
1/2 teaspoon salt
1/4 teaspoon black pepper
(optional toppings: chopped fresh parsley, extra Parmesan)

1. Cook pasta al dente according to package directions in boiling water.
2. Meanwhile, heat olive oil or melt butter in a large sauté pan over medium-high heat. Add garlic and sauté for about one minute, stirring occasionally, until fragrant. Sprinkle with flour, and stir to combine. Sauté for an additional minute to cook the flour, stirring occasionally.
3. Slowly add the chicken broth, whisking to combine until smooth. Whisk in milk, and bring the mixture to a simmer. Let the sauce cook for an additional minute until thickened, then stir in Parmesan cheese, salt and pepper until the cheese is melted.
4. Drain pasta, then immediately add it to the sauce. Toss to combine. Serve topped with chopped fresh parsley and extra parmesan if desired.

Recipe adapted from gimmesomeoven.com



Pesto Tortellini

6-20 oz. cheese or spinach and cheese tortellini (amount depends on how much you want)
Bottle of pesto
1-1 ½ grilled or baked chicken breast (optional)

1. Cook the desired amount of pasta that you want. Once cooked, drain the tortellini and return it back to the pot.
2. Add chicken if desired.
3. Add one or two spoonfuls of pesto and mix to combine everything. Add more pesto to your liking and heat on low to medium heat until the mixture is warmed through. Serve immediately.

Fish

Fish can seem intimidating to make, but it is really very simple because it doesn't take very long to cook. The hardest thing with fish is how expensive it can be. Look for sales on fish and freeze a few filets for easy use later.

How to Cook Most Types of Fish

These methods work well with fish like salmon, tilapia, Mahi Mahi, cod, and halibut.

Bake:

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F for thawed fish or 400°F for frozen fish. Spray a 9x9 or 13x9 inch glass pan with cooking spray.
2. Season your fish filets as desired. Some ideas are lemon pepper seasoning, Cajun seasoning, garlic and onion powder, butter and lemon, or whatever type of seasoning you like best. Add the filets to the pan.
3. Bake for about 15-20 minutes or until the fish flakes easily with a fork.

Pan Fry:

1. Heat a sauté pan over medium heat. Pour about 1-1 ½ tablespoons of olive oil in the pan and heat until the oil shimmers.
2. While the oil is heating, season your fish as desired (see above for some seasoning ideas).
3. Add your fish filets to the pan and cook for about 5-7 minutes on each side until the fish flakes easily with a fork.

Tacos or Burritos

Another quick and easy dinner idea is tacos or burritos. These can be made with any type of meat (beef, chicken, pork, shrimp) or can easily be made vegetarian or vegan with rice, beans, and veggies. Make your taco a salad by adding your toppings on to lettuce instead of a tortilla.

How to Cook Taco Meat:

1. Choose which type of meat you like best. You can cook your meat thawed or frozen.
2. Chicken can easily be baked in the oven at 375°F for around 35-40 minutes. Or you can pan fry the chicken over the stove.
3. Ground beef is best cooked in a sauté pan. Once the meat is cooked until it is no longer pink, drain the extra juice from the pan and pat the meat with a paper towel to remove additional drippings.
4. Whatever type of meat you choose, season it with taco seasoning from a packet or make your own by simply mixing all these ingredients together. 2-3 tbsp. of this mix is equivalent to a packet of taco mix:

- 1/3 cup dry minced onion
- 2 tsp salt
- 2 tbsp. chili powder
- 2 tbsp. paprika
- 1 tsp garlic powder
- 1 tsp cumin
- ½ tsp oregano
- 2 tbsp. flour



Topping Ideas:

Lettuce
Tomato
Avocado or guacamole
Salsa
Cilantro
Sour cream or plain yogurt
Hot sauce

Lentil Tacos

Here is super delicious vegetarian take on tacos using lentils, which are very high in protein.

½ tbsp. olive oil
1 cup finely chopped onion
1 clove garlic, minced
1 cup dried brown lentils, rinsed (check for small dirt clods and rocks)
1 package of low sodium taco seasoning (or make your own using the recipe on page 39)
2 ¼ cups water
Tortillas
Toppings of choice

1. In a large saucepan or skillet over medium-high heat, heat oil. Add the onion and garlic and cook until the onions begin to soften.
2. Add lentils and taco seasoning to pan. Cook until the spices are fragrant and the lentils are dry, about 1 minute or so.
3. Add the water to the lentils and bring to a boil. Reduce heat to low, cover the lentils, and simmer until the lentils are tender and most of the liquid is gone, about 25-30 minutes but cook longer if needed. Uncover the lentils and continue to cook until the mixture thickens, about 3-5 minutes more.
4. Once the lentils are cooked, make up your tacos with all your favorite toppings!

Recipe adapted from and courtesy of Anna Allen.